

OLS preservation policy

Ontology Lookup Service

Version 1.00 | 2 October 2026

Purpose

OLS aims to preserve its released software for continued access, citation and reuse, including after the live service ends. The latest code release is archived on Zenodo under [10.5281/zenodo.23184947](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23184947).

Archiving and access

New public production releases will be archived on Zenodo with their own version-specific DOIs. Each deposit will identify the software version and source commit, and include the source code, licence, release information and available build and deployment documentation, including dependency details.

The OLS team will check that each published deposit is accessible and matches the stated release. OLS documentation will link to the archive, and users should cite the DOI for the version used. Earlier archived releases will remain available, subject to Zenodo's policies. Reuse is governed by the licences supplied with the material.

Scope and retention

This policy covers OLS software and the documentation included in each deposit. Ontology datasets and historical API responses are covered only when explicitly archived. Users needing historical ontology content should retain and cite the relevant ontology versions.

Archived releases have no planned deletion date; retention is subject to Zenodo's preservation and withdrawal policies. Preservation does not guarantee continued operation of the OLS website or API, or compatibility with future software environments.

Responsibility and service closure

The OLS team is responsible for maintaining archive links and reviewing this policy annually. If the service closes, the team will archive the final code and documentation, publish a notice directing users to the persistent records, and seek a successor where feasible.